Cornell University

Consent

Study Consent Form

What the study is about: This study examines a set of questions related to one's mindset and perceptions of work.

What we will ask you to do: The initial survey will ask a series of questions about your opinions and should take approximately 5-7 minutes to complete.

Compensation: All participants who complete the study will receive between $.50-1.25 via Prolific.

Confidentiality and privacy: The answers you provide to the survey will be held in strict confidentiality and will only be used for the purposes of this study. The results will be reported in aggregate form only, and cannot be identified individually.

Risks: We do not anticipate any risks to you participating in this study other than those encountered in day-to-day life.

Benefits: No direct benefits are expected from participation in this research. You might find it beneficial that your participation helps science, increases new knowledge, and may benefit other people in the future by advantage the field of moral psychology.

Eligibility: Anyone 18 or older in the US is eligible to participate in this study.

Taking part is voluntary: Your participation in this study is voluntary. You may stop participation at any point, for any reason. You may skip a question, several questions, discontinue at any time, with no penalty or effect on compensation or ability to participate in future studies with Prolific or Cornell University.

If you have questions: The lead researcher conducting this study is Professor Laura Niemi at Cornell University. Please contact Dr. Niemi (ln279@cornell.edu) with any questions you may have. If you have any questions or concerns regarding your rights as a subject in this study, you may contact Cornell University's Institutional Review Board (IRB) at 607-255-5138 or access their website at http://www.irb.cornell.edu. You may also report your concerns or complaints anonymously through Ethicspoint or by calling toll free at 1-866-293-3077. Ethicspoint is an independent organization that serves as a liaison between the University and the person bringing the complaint so that anonymity can be ensured.

Statement of Consent: I have read the above information, and have received answers to any questions that I had. By clicking on the arrow below, I acknowledge that I am at least 18 years old and that I consent to take part in the study.

○ Accept

Instructions

Welcome to the survey!
We are interested in your opinions about a company called *SerVest*.

Like many companies, *SerVest's* mission is to make sure customers are treated in a professional, friendly, and patient manner.

Currently, the company is working to improve operations.

Agency Condition

***SerVest* has a Customer Service Policy for its employees. Here is an excerpt:**

"At *SerVest*, we acknowledge that personal values might vary. *SerVest* trusts you to make customer service decisions that reflect *your* personal values"

What does the Customer Service Policy at SerVest say about how employees should make company decisions?

○ They are trusted to make decisions that reflect their personal values
○ They should make decisions that reflect the mission of SerVest
○ I have no idea

Thank you! Please answer the following questions as though you are an employee at *SerVest*, where you are trusted to make customer service decisions that reflect your personal values

A.actual_1

Please consider the following possibility.

In customer service at **SerVest** today, a customer **yelled** at you, **refused to listen** to you, **cut you off** mid sentence, used **condescending** language to you, and **argued with you the whole time** throughout the call.

Based on the Service Policy's trust of you to make decisions that reflect your values, how likely is it that you would actually do the following:

Refuse to address the customer's issue even though you could

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Intentionally put the customer on hold for a long period of time

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Purposefully transfer the customer to the wrong department

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Purposefully disconnect the call

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Tell the customer that you fixed the issue, even though you did not fix it

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Why did you choose those particular responses? (Choose all that apply):

☐ Personal moral reasons
☐ A sense of obligation to the employer
☐ The customer deserved this behavior
☐ I wanted to communicate a standard of appropriate behavior to the customer
☐ Other (please specify):

Remember that in customer service at **SerVest** today, a customer **yelled** at you, **refused to listen** to you, **cut you off** mid sentence, used **condescending** language to you, and **argued with you the whole time** throughout the call.

Based on the Service Policy's trust of you to make decisions that reflect your values, how likely is it that you would actually do the following:

Try to deescalate the situation over the phone

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Seek assistance from a colleague or manager

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Fix their issue as fast as possible

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Tough it out by disregarding the customer's behaviors

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Politely ask the customer to refrain from these behaviors

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Why did you choose those particular responses? (Choose all that apply):

☐ Personal moral reasons
☐ A sense of obligation to the employer
☐ The customer deserved this behavior
☐ I wanted to communicate a standard of appropriate behavior to the customer
☐ Other (please specify):

A.actual_2

Please consider the following possibility.

In customer service at **SerVest** today, an irate customer **insulted** you, loudly **sighed** whenever you tried to speak, **demanded** that you do something that you weren't allowed to do, and **claimed** that you should be fired for being so terrible at your job.

Based on the Service Policy's trust of you to make decisions that reflect the mission of SerVest, how likely is it that you would actually do the following:

Refuse to address the customer's issue even though you could

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Intentionally put the customer on hold for a long period of time

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Purposefully transfer the customer to the wrong department

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Purposefully disconnect the call

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Tell the customer that you fixed the issue, even though you did not fix it

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Why did you choose those particular responses? (Choose all that apply):

☐ Personal moral reasons
☐ A sense of obligation to the employer
☐ The customer deserved this behavior
☐ I wanted to communicate a standard of appropriate behavior to the customer
☐ Other (please specify):

Remember that in customer service at **SerVest** today, an irate customer **insulted** you, loudly **sighed** whenever you tried to speak, **demanded** that you do something that you weren't allowed to do, and **claimed** that you should be fired for being so terrible at your job.

Based on the Service Policy's trust of you to make decisions that reflect the mission of SerVest, how likely is it that you would actually do the following:

Try to deescalate the situation over the phone

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Seek assistance from a colleague or manager

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Fix their issue as fast as possible

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Tough it out by disregarding the customer's behaviors

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Politely ask the customer to refrain from these behaviors

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Why did you choose those particular responses? (Choose all that apply):

☐ Personal moral reasons
☐ A sense of obligation to the employer
☐ The customer deserved this behavior
☐ I wanted to communicate a standard of appropriate behavior to the customer
☐ Other (please specify):

A.actual_3

Please consider the following possibility.

In customer service at **SerVest** today, an outraged customer was **hostile** towards you, **called** you names, **mocked** your speaking style, said that you worked for a worthless company and **questioned** your integrity.

Based on the Service Policy's trust of you to make decisions that reflect your values, how likely is it that you would actually do the following:

Refuse to address the customer's issue even though you could

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Intentionally put the customer on hold for a long period of time

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Purposefully transfer the customer to the wrong department

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Purposefully disconnect the call

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Tell the customer that you fixed the issue, even though you did not fix it

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Why did you choose those particular responses? (Choose all that apply):

☐ Personal moral reasons
☐ A sense of obligation to the employer
☐ The customer deserved this behavior
☐ I wanted to communicate a standard of appropriate behavior to the customer
☐ Other (please specify):

Remember that in customer service at **SerVest** today, an outraged customer was **hostile** towards you, **called** you names, **mocked** your speaking style, said that you worked for a worthless company and **questioned** your integrity.

Based on the Service Policy's trust of you to make decisions that reflect your values, how likely is it that you would actually do the following:

Try to deescalate the situation over the phone

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Seek assistance from a colleague or manager

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Fix their issue as fast as possible

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Tough it out by disregarding the customer's behaviors

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Politely ask the customer to refrain from these behaviors

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Why did you choose those particular responses?

☐ Personal moral reasons
☐ A sense of obligation to the employer
☐ The customer deserved this behavior
☐ I wanted to communicate a standard of appropriate behavior to the customer
☐ Other (please specify):

EndCheck

Do you agree with the following statement?

SerVest thinks it is important that employees make ethical decisions guided by their sense of right and wrong.

Disagree	Agree
○	○

Non-Agency Condition

SerVest has a Customer Service Policy for its employees. Here is an excerpt:

"At SerVest, we acknowledge that personal values might vary. SerVest trusts you to make customer service decisions that reflect the mission of *SerVest*"

What does the Customer Service Policy at SerVest say about how employees should make company decisions?

○ They are trusted to make decisions that reflect their personal values
○ They should make decisions that reflect the mission of SerVest
○ I have no idea

Thank you! Please answer the following questions as though you are an employee at SerVest where you are trusted to make customer service decisions that reflect the mission of SerVest

NA.actual_1

Please consider the following possibility.

In customer service at **SerVest** today, a customer **yelled** at you, **refused to listen** to you, **cut you off** mid sentence, used **condescending** language to you, and **argued with you the whole time** throughout the call.

Based on the Service Policy's trust of you to make decisions that reflect the mission of SerVest, how likely is it that you would actually do the following:

Refuse to address the customer's issue even though you could

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Intentionally put the customer on hold for a long period of time

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Purposefully transfer the customer to the wrong department

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Purposefully disconnect the call

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Tell the customer that you fixed the issue, even though you did not fix it

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Why did you choose those particular responses? (Choose all that apply):

☐ Personal moral reasons
☐ A sense of obligation to the employer
☐ The customer deserved this behavior
☐ I wanted to communicate a standard of appropriate behavior to the customer
☐ Other (please specify):

Remember that in customer service at **SerVest** today, a customer **yelled** at you, **refused to listen** to you, **cut you off** mid sentence, used **condescending** language to you, and **argued with you the whole time** throughout the call.

Based on the Service Policy's trust of you to make decisions that reflect the mission of SerVest, how likely is it that you would actually do the following:

Try to deescalate the situation over the phone

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Seek assistance from a colleague or manager

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Fix their issue as fast as possible

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Tough it out by disregarding the customer's behaviors

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Politely ask the customer to refrain from these behaviors

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Why did you choose those particular responses? (Choose all that apply):

☐ Personal moral reasons
☐ A sense of obligation to the employer
☐ The customer deserved this behavior
☐ I wanted to communicate a standard of appropriate behavior to the customer
☐ Other (please specify):

NA.actual_2

Please consider the following possibility.

In customer service at **SerVest** today, an irate customer **insulted** you, loudly **sighed** whenever you tried to speak, **demanded** that you do something that you weren't allowed to do, and **claimed** that you should be fired for being so terrible at your job.

Based on the Service Policy's trust of you to make decisions that reflect the mission of SerVest, how likely is it that you would actually do the following:

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○	○	○	○	○

Intentionally put the customer on hold for a long period of time

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Purposefully transfer the customer to the wrong department

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Purposefully disconnect the call

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Tell the customer that you fixed the issue, even though you did not fix it

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Why did you choose those particular responses? (Choose all that apply):

☐ Personal moral reasons
☐ A sense of obligation to the employer
☐ The customer deserved this behavior
☐ I wanted to communicate a standard of appropriate behavior to the customer
☐ Other (please specify):

Remember that in customer service at **SerVest** today, an irate customer **insulted** you, loudly **sighed** whenever you tried to speak, **demanded** that you do something that you weren't allowed to do, and **claimed** that you should be fired for being so terrible at your job.

Based on the Service Policy's trust of you to make decisions that reflect the mission of SerVest, how likely is it that you would actually do the following:

Try to deescalate the situation over the phone

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○	○	○	○	○

Seek assistance from a colleague or manager

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Fix their issue as fast as possible

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
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Tough it out by disregarding the customer's behaviors

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Politely ask the customer to refrain from these behaviors

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Why did you choose those particular responses? (Choose all that apply):

☐ Personal moral reasons
☐ A sense of obligation to the employer
☐ The customer deserved this behavior
☐ I wanted to communicate a standard of appropriate behavior to the customer
☐ Other (please specify):

NA.actual_3

Please consider the following possibility.

In customer service as SerVest today, an outraged customer was **hostile** towards you, **called** you names, **mocked** your speaking style, **said** that you worked for a worthless company, and **questioned** your integrity.

Based on the Service Policy's trust of you to make decisions that reflect the mission of SerVest, how likely is it that you would actually do the following:

Refuse to address the customer's issue even though you could

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Intentionally put the customer on hold for a long period of time

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Purposefully transfer the customer to the wrong department

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Purposefully disconnect the call

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Tell the customer that you fixed the issue, even though you did not fix it

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Why did you choose those particular responses? (Choose all that apply):

☐ Personal moral reasons
☐ A sense of obligation to the employer
☐ The customer deserved this behavior
☐ I wanted to communicate a standard of appropriate behavior to the customer
☐ Other (please specify):

Remember that in customer service at **SerVest** today, an outraged customer was **hostile** towards you, **called** you names, **mocked** your speaking style, **said** that you worked for a worthless company, and **questioned** your integrity.

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○	○	○	○	○

Seek assistance from a colleague or manager

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Fix their issue as fast as possible

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Tough it out by disregarding the customer's behaviors

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Politely ask the customer to refrain from these behaviors

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Why did you choose those particular responses? (Choose all that apply):

☐ Personal moral reasons
☐ A sense of obligation to the employer
☐ The customer deserved this behavior
☐ I wanted to communicate a standard of appropriate behavior to the customer
☐ Other (please specify):

EndCheckNA

Do you agree with the following statement:

SerVest thinks that ethical decisions at work comply with the company rules and are not based on one's own personal beliefs.

Disagree	Agree
○	○

Endinput

Thank you for your input.

Please click ahead for more information.

Thank you for your participation. We would like to describe the purpose of this study. We are interested in organizational behavior and psychology. This study presents a fictitious company, SerVest, to understand how participants approach decision-making in different situations, including situations involving customers mistreatment. Your willingness to take part in this study will help us better understand how people can be supported in their workplaces.

We appreciate your response to the next question. Please be honest when answering. Your answer will not affect your payment or eligibility for future studies.

The study you have just participated in is a psychological study aimed at understanding human cognition and behavior. Psychological research depends on participants like you. Your responses to surveys like this one are an incredibly valuable source of data for researchers. It is therefore crucial for research that participants pay attention, avoid distractions, and take all study tasks seriously (even when they might seem silly).

Do you feel that you paid attention, avoided distractions, and took this survey seriously?

○ No, I was distracted.
○ No, I had trouble paying attention.
○ No, I did not take the study seriously.
○ No, something else affected my participation negatively.
○ Yes.

Demographics

Please enter the highest level of education you have completed.

○ Some high school.
○ High school.
○ Some university/college
○ University/college
○ Graduate degree
○ Doctoral degree
○ Professional degree (e.g. M.D., J.D., etc.)
○ Other

Please enter your age

Please enter your age.

Age

Please indicate your gender.

○ Male
○ Female
○ Other

Please enter your ethnicity.

○ Hispanic or Latino
○ Not Hispanic or Latino

Please indicate your racial background.

○ White or European-American
○ Black or African-American
○ Asian or Asian-American
○ Native American or Pacific Islander
○ Multiracial
○ Other

What is your combined annual household income?

○ Less than 30,000
○ 30,000 – 39,999
○ 40,000 – 49,999
○ 50,000 – 59,999
○ 60,000 – 69,999
○ 70,000 – 79,999
○ 80,000 – 89,999
○ 90,000 – 99,999
○ 100,000 or more

When it comes to economic issues, are you:

Very Politically Conservative						Very Politically Liberal
○	○	○	○	○	○	○

When it comes to social issues, are you:

Very Politically Conservative						Very Politically Liberal
○	○	○	○	○	○	○

feedback

Thank you for your participation. Please leave any feedback or constructive comments about the study in the space below

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